WORKING NAME · SWAP FREELY

Verge

The verge is the strip between the sidewalk and the street. Nobody plants it. Things grow there anyway. The app is about looking at the places you walk past, so the name points at the most walked-past place there is.

THE ONE IDEA

Every screen is a page in a field notebook. Ruled hairlines instead of shadows. Specimen labels in mono. One serif that sounds like a person wrote the prompt by hand. The phone is something you glance at, then put away.

VOICE

Second person, present tense, plain words. Teaches, never congratulates. Says "I'm not sure" out loud. Never mentions yesterday.

THREE TYPEFACES, EACH WITH A JOB

Find three plants growing where nobody planted them.

Young Serif · prompts and answer headlines only. One weight, so it can't be overused.

The big fuzzy rosette is a first-year plant. Next summer it sends up a spike taller than you.

Atkinson Hyperlegible · all body text. Chosen because it was built for low-vision reading, which is what sunlight on glass turns everyone into.

NATURE · 10 OCT · BATES HENDRICKS

IBM Plex Mono · labels, dates, lens tags. The herbarium tag.

PALETTE



Paper, ink, moss, rule, brick. Moss is the only action color. Brick appears in exactly one place: the edible-plant safety block. Nothing else is colored for decoration.

CONFIDENCE AS PENCIL MARKS

- Confident `filled`
- Likely `half`
- Unsure `ring`
- Can't tell from this `dashed`

Shape, fill and lightness all differ, so the state reads without the word, in sun, and for red-green colorblind readers. Full rules on board 02.

NEVER DRAWN

- Progress bars, rings, flames, streak counts, percentages
- Maps, pins, star ratings, hero photos of places
- Pill buttons, drop shadows, gradient washes, emoji
- Confetti, haptic fanfare, "you missed a day"
- Empty-state nagging. An empty journal is a blank page.

COLOR.* · ALL ON PAPER UNLESS NOTED

paper #F3F2EC
ground, everywhere

paper.raised #FBFAF7
cards, sheets, inputs

ink #1B1916
text, capture button · 16.4:1

ink.soft #4E4A43
secondary text, labels · 7.9:1

rule #C9C5BA
hairlines, 1px. Replaces shadows.

moss #2E5E3E
primary action, confident · 7.6:1

ochre #8F6420
likely · 4.9:1

slate #4F6479
unsure · 5.6:1

graphite #6B665D
can't tell, silhouettes · 5.1:1

brick #9A3B2B
safety block only · 6.4:1

night #121110
camera viewfinder ground only

TYPE.* · SIZES IN PT, IOS DYNAMIC TYPE SCALES ALL

Prompt 34/40

type.prompt · Young Serif · Today screen only

Answer headline 24/30

type.headline · Young Serif · answer card, explore cards, badge names

Section 20/28 bold

type.section · Atkinson 700 · screen titles

Body 17/26. The default. Nothing reads smaller than this outdoors.

type.body · Atkinson 400

Body small 15/22, ink.soft. Context lines, tier 2 copy.

type.body.sm

LABEL 12/16 · TRACK 8%

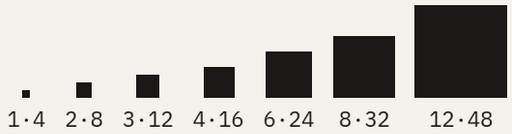
type.label · Plex Mono 500 · lens tags, dates, section labels

Button 17/24 bold

type.button · Atkinson 700

Minimum text size 15pt. Minimum contrast 4.5:1 at any size; 7:1 for body. Measure at 36 characters on 390pt. Never justified, never centered body.

SPACE.* · 4PT BASE



Screen gutter 24. Card padding 16. Stack gap 12 inside a card, 24 between cards, 48 between sections.

RADIUS.* AND SURFACE



radius.card 4 · radius.button 4 · radius.chip 2 · radius.photo 2. No pills. Elevation is a 1px rule, never a shadow; sheets get a 2px top rule in ink.

MOTION

Sheets slide 280ms ease-out. Cards don't animate in. The earned-badge card fades in over 400ms and waits. No spring, no bounce, no particle anything.

EXPO / RN NOTES

Fonts via expo-font. Tokens as a single `theme.ts` consumed by a `useTheme()` hook; no inline hexes in screens. Dark mode ships in MVP: board 01b holds the night set; the hook swaps the whole token object, so screens never branch on scheme.

CONFIDENCE.* · ONE OF FOUR, ALWAYS VISIBLE, NEVER COMPUTED AS A PERCENTAGE

The state is a mark, a word and a color, in that order of importance. The mark alone must carry it: a reader squinting at a 14pt circle in full sun can tell filled from half from ring from dashed. The word confirms. The color is a courtesy.

The four colors step down in lightness (moss darkest, graphite lightest) and are all low-chroma, so a desaturated or dim screen still orders them. Red and green never meet.

Confident

MARK filled · COLOR moss · ICON name "mark.filled"

When: the model would stake its name on it. Distinguishing features are visible and nothing common looks the same.

Voice: states the name, then why. "Common mullein. The felted grey rosette is hard to mistake."

Tier 2 teaches how to know it next time without the app.

Likely

MARK half · COLOR ochre · ICON name "mark.half"

When: the best fit is clear but one feature that would settle it isn't in the photo, or a lookalike exists.

Voice: names it and names the doubt in the same breath. "Likely Virginia creeper. Poison ivy has three leaflets; count yours."

Tier 2 leads with the one feature that would settle it.

Unsure

MARK ring · COLOR slate · ICON name "mark.ring"

When: two or three candidates, none favored. The answer is a short list, not a name.

Voice: offers the candidates as a choice the walker can make. "Bricked-in window, or a doorway that was never one. Here's how you'd tell."

Tier 2 becomes a comparison: this if, that if.

Can't tell from this

MARK dashed · COLOR graphite · ICON name "mark.dashed"

When: the capture doesn't contain the information. Not an error; a true statement about the photo.

Voice: says what it *can* see, then exactly what would help. Never apologizes. "A moth, wings closed. Wing pattern is how moths are told apart. A shot from above with wings open would do it."

Tier 2 is replaced by "What would help": two concrete asks plus "Leave it a mystery," which is a real option.

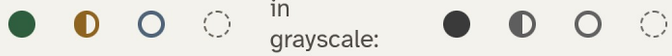
WHERE THE MARK APPEARS

- Answer card header, 24pt, beside the word
- Journal cards, 14pt, after the answer line
- Badge "Honest observer" uses the dashed mark as its emblem
- Nowhere else. It is not a status indicator for the app.

RULES

- Never a number, bar or gauge. "Likely" is the whole precision.
- Edible or medicinal finds are capped at "Likely" in the headline and always carry the safety block, even when Confident.
- Resolving a "Can't tell" with a second photo re-runs the find and keeps the original capture in the

THE GLANCE TEST, 14PT, AS ON A JOURNAL CARD



STRUCTURE · THREE DESTINATIONS, ONE SHEET, ONE SETTINGS STACK

Today

Tab 1. Home. One prompt.

Capture

Center action, not a tab. Opens camera modally from anywhere.

Journal

Tab 2. Finds, then Badges beneath.

Explore sheet
Bottom sheet over Today. Five alternates. Tap sets today's lens and closes.

Answer card
Pushed after capture. Also opened from any Journal card. Back returns to origin.

Badges
Section below the Journal list, reached by scrolling or the "Badges" link in the Journal header.

Settings
Gear in the Today header. Stack: Lenses · Morning invitation · Location · Export journal · About.

Tab bar: two text labels and the ink capture square, 92pt tall including the home-indicator inset. Labels are words, not icons: "Today", "Journal". The capture square is the only non-text control on the bar and the only ink-filled surface in the app, so it is findable from any screen by shape alone.

Where the capture button lives: tab bar on Today and Journal; a floating version in the same place on the Answer card (so a follow-up find is one tap); hidden on Capture itself, in sheets, and in Settings.

FLOWS

The daily loop
Today → (Explore) → walk → Capture → Answer c
→ Journal. Five taps end to end, three of them the
camera.

Note-only capture
Capture → "Note instead" → text field → Answer c
The answer treats a note like a photo it can't see:
Unsure or Can't tell, and that is fine.

Resolving a Can't tell
Answer card → "Add a photo" → Capture (with the
original find attached) → re-run → same card, new
state. Earns Honest observer on first resolve.

First launch
Onboarding 1–3 (skippable from screen 1; skippin
leaves all lenses Neutral, invitation off) → Today.

Morning invitation tap
Deep-links to Today with the prompt already up. N
interstitial.

Expo Router: `(tabs)/today`, `(tabs)/journal`
modal group for `capture` and `explore`, stack fo
`find/[id]` and `settings/*`.

INVENTORY · 14 COMPONENTS, ONE FILE EACH UNDER COMPONENTS/

PrimaryButton / SecondaryButton

I'll try it Show me others

52pt, radius 4. Secondary is text only. Never two filled buttons on a screen.

CaptureButton



Ink square, viewfinder glyph. Long-press opens note-only directly.

LensTag / LensChip

NATURE ALL BUILT HISTORY

Tag is inline mono. Chip is the journal filter: 32pt, radius 2, selected = ink fill. Lenses: Nature · Built · History · Light & weather · Signs & people · Surprise.

ConfidenceMark + ConfidenceHeader

 LIKELY

Mark sizes 14 / 24. Header = mark + word in mono caps in the state color. Board 02 has the rules.

TierSection

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Leaves feel like felt. That alone rules out most lookalikes.

Mono label over body. Rule above, never a card inside a card. Tiers 1–3 are three of these.

FollowUpQuestion + AskBox

Why is it growing in a crack? →

Ask about this find

Three questions max. AskBox is scoped to the find; placeholder says so.

SafetyBlock

BEFORE YOU TASTE ANYTHING

Don't eat or use anything on the strength of an app.

Fixed copy, no close, no collapse, rendered above tier 2 whenever the find is tagged edible or medicinal. Brick appears nowhere else.

ReactionRow

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more

Single-select, ink fill when chosen. Feeds the next prompt's lean. "Tell me more" opens the answer card at tier 3.

JournalCard



NATURE · 10 OCT

Common mullein

Photo 64 square, radius 2, or a note glyph. Rules between cards, no card chrome. The photo is never cropped to a hero.

LensStateControl

Curious | Neutral | Skip

Three-state segmented, 40pt. Default Neutral. "Skip" still gets the 1-in-4 off-topic prompt.

BadgeStamp



Earned: ink line stamp. Next-up: dashed ring, grey silhouette. Hidden: not drawn.

PromptCard · Sheet · Toggle · Notification

PromptCard (Explore): headline + lens tag + duration, 1px rule border. Sheet: paper.raised, 2px ink top rule, grab handle. Toggle: iOS native, tinted moss. Notification: system style; title is the app name, body is the prompt, nothing else. All drawn on the screen boards.

COLOR.* NIGHT · SAME NAMES, SWAPPED VALUES

paper → night #121110
not pure black; warm, like the camera ground

paper.raised → #1E1C19
cards, sheets, inputs

ink → chalk #EDEBE4
text · 15.6:1. Not #FFF; pure white halates at night.

ink.soft → #B5B0A5
secondary · 8.7:1

rule → #3A3733
hairlines; raised surfaces need them more here

moss → #6FA882
action, confident · 7.6:1 · ink text on it: 9:1

ochre → #C99A4A
likely · 8.1:1

slate → #8FA6BD
unsure · 8.4:1

graphite → #9C968B
can't tell · 6.6:1

brick → #D9705C
safety block only · 6.3:1

THE MARKS, ON NIGHT

- Confident
- Likely
- Unsure
- Can't tell from this

Lightness order flips with the scheme (moss is now the lightest), but the four still step, and shape still carries the state alone.

TYPE ON NIGHT

Find where the late light lands last on your block.

Weights unchanged. Light-on-dark reads a touch bolder, so body stays 400 and we don't compensate.

WHAT CHANGES BESIDES COLOR

- The capture square inverts: chalk fill, night glyph. Still the only filled square on the bar.
- Primary button: moss fill with **ink** text, not chalk; it is the one place dark text sits on a light surface.
- Photos get a 1px rule so they don't bleed into the ground.
- Specimen label border: chalk at 100%, same as light.
- Camera is already night in both schemes; nothing changes there.
- Explore and location sheets: raised night with a 2px chalk top rule.

BEHAVIOR

Follows the phone by default. Settings › Appearance offers Follow the phone / Day / Night. No automatic sunset switching: the point of the app is to go outside, and the phone already knows the time.

I'll try it

Show me others

SATURDAY 10 OCT

NATURE

Find three plants growing where nobody planted them.

Good for 15 minutes. Fine in rain.

I'll try it

Show me others

SATURDAY 10 OCT

Find three plants

Other ways to look

Close

Tap one and it becomes today's.

BUILT — 20 MIN

Find the oldest-looking door on your street. What gives its age away?

HISTORY — 30 MIN

Look for a building that was clearly something else before.

LIGHT & WEATHER — 10 MIN · NEEDS SUN

Find where the late light lands last on your block.

SIGNS & PEOPLE — 15 MIN

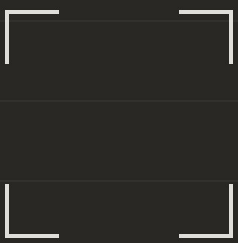
Read every hand-made sign between here and the corner.

SURPRISE — AS LONG AS IT TAKES

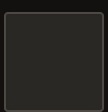
Walk a street you've only ever driven

Cancel

NATURE · TODAY'S LENS



Live camera. Fills the frame; no filters, no zoom UI.







Note instead, no photo

ASKED ONCE, AT YOUR FIRST FIND

Want to remember where this was?

If you say yes, each find keeps the spot it was made. That is what lets the app notice when you've come back to the same corner in a different season.

The location stays on your phone with the find. It is never sent anywhere, never shown on a map, and never used to suggest places. You can turn it off in Settings and nothing else changes.

Yes, remember where

Not now

"Yes" opens the iOS prompt next; we ask for "while using" only, with precise location off.

Journal

Badges

ALL | NATURE | BUILT | HISTORY | LIGHT

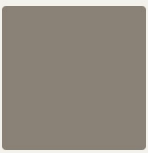


NATURE · TODAY, 11:40

Common mullein

First-year rosette in a sidewalk crack. Next year it spikes.

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more



NATURE · THU 8 OCT

A moth, wings closed

Still a mystery. A shot from above would settle it.

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more

BUILT · TUE 6 OCT · NOTE

Bricked-in opening on Lincoln St

Window or doorway. The sill line would tell you.

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more



LIGHT & WEATHER · SUN 4 OCT

Likely a sun dog

Today | Journal

Badges

Each one marks something you now know how to see. Most stay hidden until you earn them.

FIRST FINDS



First photo



First note



First question

FIELD NATURALIST · ONE PER LENS, 5 · 15 · 40 FINDS



Nature I



Nature II



Built I



History I

HONEST OBSERVER



Resolved

Go back to a "can't tell" with a better look. You have one waiting: the moth.

WINDOW OPENER



Signs & people

A find through a lens you've marked Skip.

Journal



Common mullein

FIELD NATURALIST · NATURE I

Five finds through the nature lens.

You can now tell a first-year mullein from a second, and you know what a sidewalk crack grows. That's what this one is for.

EARNED 10 OCT

Noted

Spec: fades in over 400ms after the answer card closes. One button. No sound, no haptic, no confetti. Shown once; afterward the badge is simply filled in on the Badges list.

← Settings

Lenses

Prompts lean toward what you're curious about. One in four ignores this on purpose.

Wild plants	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip
Birds, bugs and other animals	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip
Buildings and how they are made	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip
History and what used to be here	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip
Light, sky and weather	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip
Signs, lettering, hand-made things	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip
Water, soil and stone	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip
Streets and how people use them	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip
Trees	**Curious**	Neutral	Skip

"Skip" means fewer, not none. The first find through a skipped lens earns Window opener.

← Today

Settings

Lenses
3 curious · 1 skipped →

Morning invitation
On, 7:30 →

Remember where finds were made
Stays on this phone. Needed for "Same spot, new season." [toggle on]

Export journal
Photos, notes and answers as a folder you own. →

Appearance
Follows the phone →

About, and what we don't collect →

No account. Nothing leaves the phone except the photo you choose to ask about.



LENS NATURE
DATE 10 OCT 2026
WHERE NEAR HOME
CONF. CONFIDENT

Common mullein

The big felted grey-green rosette is a first-year plant. Next summer it sends up a single spike taller than you, covered in small yellow flowers.

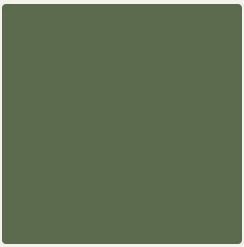
WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Touch a leaf. If it feels like flannel, you have it; lamb's ear is softer and smaller, and nothing else in a sidewalk crack is fuzzy at all.

GO DEEPER

Photo first; a mono label block, like the tag pinned to a herbarium sheet, holds the metadata and the confidence mark together. The answer reads as a specimen entry. Strongest brand, most "notebook."

Is it from here? →



CONFIDENT

Common mullein

NATURE · 10 OCT

The big felted grey-green rosette is a first-year plant. Next summer it sends up a single spike taller than you, covered in small yellow flowers.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Touch a leaf. If it feels like flannel, you have it; lamb's ear is softer and smaller, and nothing else in a sidewalk crack is fuzzy at all.

GO DEEPER

- Why is it growing in a crack? →
- Is it from here? →
- What else looks like this? →

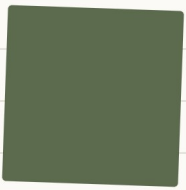
Confidence runs down the left margin as a stripe in the state color, so it is visible however far you scroll. Photo is a square thumbnail, text leads. Fastest to scan, but the stripe is a familiar app pattern and the photo loses respect.

← Journal

DIRECTION C

CONFIDENT

Common mullein



NATURE · 10 OCT

The big felted grey-green rosette is a first-year plant. Next summer it sends up a single spike taller than you, covered in small yellow flowers.

What to look for

Go deeper

Ruled index card with a colored header band; tiers 2 and 3 fold away. Charming once, but the color band reads as an alert banner, the skeuomorphism gets old by the tenth find, and folding tier 2 hides the teaching, which is the point.



LENS NATURE
WHERE NEAR HOME
DATE 10 OCT 2026
CONFIDENT

Common mullein

The big felted grey-green rosette is a first-year plant. Next summer it sends up a single spike taller than you, covered in small yellow flowers.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Touch a leaf. If it feels like flannel, you have it. Lamb's ear is softer and smaller; nothing else in a sidewalk crack is fuzzy at all. The leaves spiral out from one center, biggest at the bottom.

GO DEEPER

- Why is it growing in a crack? →
- Is it from here, or did it arrive? →
- What was it used for? →

Ask about this find

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more



LENS NATURE
DATE 9 OCT 2026
WHERE NEAR HOME
LIKELY

Likely Virginia creeper

A fast vine on the fence with leaves in fans of five. It turns a deep red early in fall, often before any tree does. The one thing the photo doesn't show is the leaflet count up close, and that's what separates it from poison ivy.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

Count the leaflets on one leaf. Five from a single point: Virginia creeper. Three: poison ivy, and don't touch it. Creeper also climbs with little suction pads at the tendril tips; ivy climbs with hairy rootlets along the stem.

GO DEEPER

- Why does it turn red so early? →
- Is it bad for the fence? →
- Who eats the berries? →

Ask about this find

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more

> "Brick wall on Lincoln St with a bricked-in rectangle at about chest height, different mortar color, slightly recessed."

LENS BUILT
WHERE NOT RECORDED
DATE 6 OCT 2026
UNSURE

A window, or a doorway that was never one

Chest height and recessed points to a filled window; different mortar means it was done years after the wall. But some old shops had low delivery hatches, and a note can't show me the sill.

HOW YOU'D TELL

Window if
A stone or brick sill sticks out at the bottom, and there's a matching opening on the floor above.

Hatch if
No sill, iron hinge pins or a lintel wider than the opening, and it sits right at the sidewalk.

GO DEEPER

Why would someone brick up a window? →

How old is the mortar color telling me it is? →

Add a photo next time you pass →

Ask about this find

LENS NATURE
WHERE NEAR HOME
DATE 8 OCT 2026
CAN'T TELL FROM THIS

A moth, resting with its wings closed

The photo is sharp enough to see it's a moth and not a butterfly: thick body, feathery antennae, wings folded flat like a tent. Which moth is written on the upper wings, and those are tucked away.

WHAT WOULD HELP

Any one of these would probably do it. Moths at rest usually stay put if you move slowly.

- A shot from directly above, if it opens its wings →
- A note on size: bigger than a quarter, or smaller? →

Leave it a mystery →

GO DEEPER ANYWAY

- Why do moths rest on walls in daylight? →
- How many kinds live around here? →

Ask about this find

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more

LENS NATURE
WHERE NEAR HOME
DATE 10 OCT 2026
LIKELY

Likely wild grape

Small dark clusters on a vine with big lobed leaves and curling tendrils. Riverbank grape grows all through this part of the state and is heavy with fruit in October.

BEFORE YOU TASTE ANYTHING

Don't eat or use anything on the strength of an app. This is a starting point, not a safe-to-eat verdict. Lookalikes exist: for grape, that's moonseed, which is poisonous and grows in the same places. A photo can't tell ripe from unripe or sprayed from unsprayed. If foraging interests you, a local guide or the county extension office is the next step.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

Open one fruit. Grape has several small pear-shaped seeds. Moonseed has one flat seed shaped like a crescent moon, and its tendrils are absent; the vine twines instead.

GO DEEPER

Who planted the first grape here? →

What eats them besides people? →

Ask about this find

Spec: the block is a fixed component with no close control, placed between tier 1 and tier 2, rendered whenever the find carries an edible or medicinal tag. Headline confidence is capped at Likely for these finds. Brick is used nowhere else in

Skip all

Verge

Your neighborhood, looked at again.

Each morning there is one small reason to walk out the door and look at something. You notice a thing, point your phone at it, and get told what it is and how sure we are. The journal keeps what caught your eye.

No steps counted. No streaks. Nothing to keep up with.

Next

2 OF 3

Skip

What are you curious about?

Tap what you'd like to notice more. Leave the rest. You can change this any time.

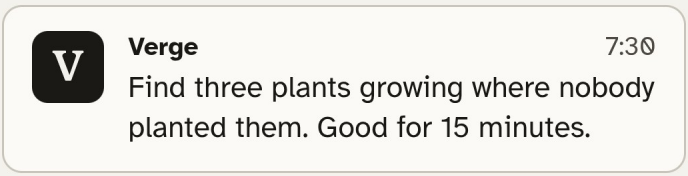
- [x] Wild plants
- [ ] Birds, bugs and other animals
- [x] Buildings and how they are made
- [ ] History and what used to be here
- [ ] Light, sky and weather
- [ ] Signs, lettering, hand-made things
- [ ] Water, soil and stone
- [ ] Streets and how people use them
- [x] Trees

Next

Skip

Want the prompt each morning?

One notification a day, with the day's prompt and nothing else. If you don't go, nothing happens. We won't mention it.



Time

Any time is fine. Pick when you'd actually step out.

7:30

Yes, in the morning

I'll open it myself

Saturday, October 10

7:30

Verge now

Find three plants growing where nobody planted them. Good for 15 minutes. Fine in rain.

Spec. Local notification, no server. Title: app name. Body: the prompt and its context line, verbatim from Today, so the words you read on the lock screen are the words you find when you open it. No "Good morning", no first name, no emoji, no "you haven't walked since", ever. Tapping deep-links to Today. If the day's prompt was already changed via Explore before the notification fires, the body is the chosen one. Interruption level: active, not time-sensitive. Shown once; never re-delivered.

← Settings

Morning invitation

Send the day's prompt

At 7:30

Weekends too
Off means Monday to Friday only.

This is the only notification the app sends. It carries the prompt and nothing else. It never reminds you, never counts days, and never asks where you've been.

Turning it off changes nothing in the journal.

Uses the phone's own time picker. If notifications are off at the system level, this row shows "Allowed in iOS Settings" with a link instead of the toggle.

SATURDAY 10 OCT

LIGHT & WEATHER

Find where the late light lands last on your block.

Good for 10 minutes. Needs a clear evening.

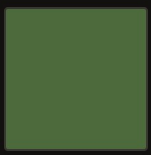
I'll try it

Show me others

Journal

Badges

ALL | NATURE | BUILT | HISTORY | LIGHT



NATURE · TODAY, 18:52

Likely Virginia creeper

Count the leaflets: five, not three.

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more



NATURE · TODAY, 11:40

Common mullein

First-year rosette in a sidewalk crack. Next year it spikes.

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more



NATURE · THU 8 OCT

A moth, wings closed

Still a mystery. A shot from above would settle it.

BUILT · TUE 6 OCT · NOTE

Bricked-in opening on Lincoln St

Today | Journal



LENS NATURE
WHERE NEAR HOME
DATE 10 OCT 2026
LIKELY

Likely Virginia creeper

A fast vine on the fence with leaves in fans of five. It turns a deep red early in fall, often before any tree does. The one thing the photo doesn't show is the leaflet count up close, and that's what separates it from poison ivy.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

Count the leaflets on one leaf. Five from a single point: Virginia creeper. Three: poison ivy, and don't touch it. Creeper also climbs with little suction pads at the tendril tips; ivy climbs with hairy rootlets along the stem.

GO DEEPER

- Why does it turn red so early? →
- Is it bad for the fence? →
- Who eats the berries? →

Ask about this find

Interesting | Not for me | Tell me more